adrian zhang

(re)birth

for large orchestra

(2024)

instrumentation:

3 flutes (flute 3 doubling piccolo)
3 oboes (oboe 2 doubling english horn)
3 clarinets in Bb (clarinet 3 doubling bass clarinet in Bb)
3 bassoons (bassoon 2 doubling contrabassoon)
4 horns in F
3 trumpets in C
3 trombones (trombone 3 doubling bass trombone)
1 tuba
1 large nipple gong
1 small tam-tam
1 marimba
1 vibraphone
1 harp
1 piano
12 1st violins
10 2nd violins
8 violas
6 violoncellos
4 double basses
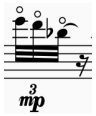
performance notes:

for all instruments:
ord. = ordinary playing
subito = suddenly

 = quarter-tone higher

 = quarter-tone lower

for harp:

 = a hollow circle above a note indicates harmonics. The exact sounding pitch is written, but it is played using harmonics.

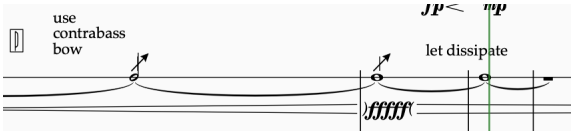
bisb. = bisbigliando

for percussion:

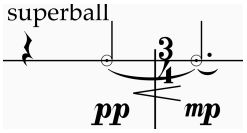
Two players should be in the percussion section - one for the gong and marimba, and the other for the tam-tam and vibraphone.

l.v. = let vibrate

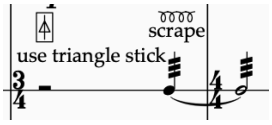
for nipple gong/tam-tam:



= indicates the use of a bow (from preferably a contrabass) in order to play across the gong. This technique is specific to the gong.
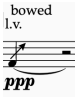


= a hollow note head with a dot in the center indicates the use of a superball to slide across the gong. The exact technique (e.g. slide distance, direction and pattern) is up to the performer. This technique is specific to the gong.



= indicates the use of a triangle stick to scrape the gong or tam-tam. The exact technique (e.g. scrape distance, direction and pattern) is up to the performer, but it should be done in a burst of quick scrapes.

for vibraphone/marimba:

By default, the motor for both instruments is switched on. Both instruments' motors are never switched off for the duration of the piece.



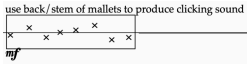
= indicates a bowed note, which means the vibraphone is played by a cello or double bass bow instead of a mallet. This is specific to the vibraphone.



= indicates a switch to soft mallets (the default for a vibraphone).



= indicates a switch to hard mallets (the default for a marimba).



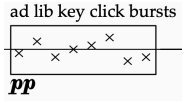
= indicates the hitting of the mallet stems together in order to produce a clicking sound. These should be played in bursts with varied rhythm. These are also usually continued by an arrow. Where the arrow ends, the key clicks stop, unless the arrow is split by a page break - in this case, the performer should keep playing until the next arrow end.

for woodwinds:

a2/a3 = all instruments play

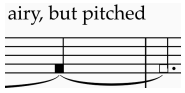
1./2./3. or 1. 2. or 2. 3. or 1. 3. or 1. 2. 3. = indicates which instrument out of 2 or 3 instruments play.

flz. = flatterzunge/flutter-tongue

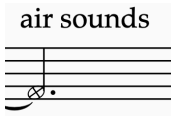


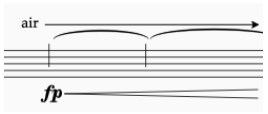
= indicates a series of key clicks. These should be played in bursts with varied rhythm. These are also usually continued by an arrow. Where the arrow ends, the key clicks stop, unless the arrow is split by a page

break - in this case, the performer should keep playing until the next arrow end.
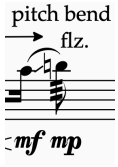


= indicates a note that has pitch, but is airy. This can be considered a midway point between air sounds and regular pitch.



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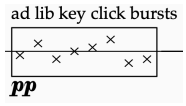
= a headless note or a hollow “x” notehead for longer notes indicates blowing of air into the instrument. The sound should be hollow, like a *woosh.*



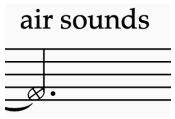
= a glissando with a slur above it indicates a pitch bend. This is a smooth glissando from note to note, with no audible separation in half-tones.

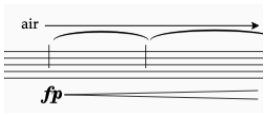
for brass instruments:

straight mutes are needed for all horns in f, trombones 1 and 2, and the tuba.
con sord. = con sordino (with mute)
senza sord. = senza sordino (without mute)
a2/a3 = all instruments play
1./2./3. or 1. 2. or 2. 3. or 1. 3. or 1. 2. 3. = indicates which instrument out of 2 or 3 instruments play.
flz. = flatterzunge/flutter-tongue



= indicates a series of key clicks. These should be played in bursts with varied rhythm. These are usually continued by an arrow. Where the arrow ends, the key clicks stop, unless the arrow is split by a page break - in this case, the performer should keep playing until the next arrow end.
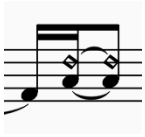


, 

= a headless note or a hollow “x” notehead for longer notes indicates blowing of air into the instrument. The sound should be hollow, like a *woosh.*
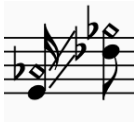
for string instruments:

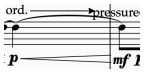
tourte mutes are required for the cellos and double basses.
con sord. = con sordino (with mute)
senza sord. = senza sordino (without mute)
s.p. = sul ponticello. Molto sul pont./molto sul ponticello is an exaggerated form of sul ponticello, and means that the player should play on the bridge.
s.t. = sul tasto
pizz. = pizzicato
vib. = vibrato. Molto vibrato is an exaggerated form of vibrato.
col legno batt. = col legno battuto. Flying col legno battuto is col legno battuto played with one bowing motion. If coupled with a glissando, flying col legno battuto is notated like 

.

 = a diamond notehead indicates use of artificial harmonics. Harmonics are also naturally notated with numbers (e.g. I, II, III, IV, like 

).

 = is a harmonic glissando.



= pressure indicates that the given passage should be played with more bow pressure, enough to make a friction-like sound.

program note:

(re)birth explores the cycle of birth, life, death, and rebirth. It signifies this cycle through the deliberate placement of ideas from the harmonic series; these ideas both begin and end certain passages, as well as the piece itself.

As *(re)birth* weaves between mechanical and organic structures, it demonstrates that the events between periods of growth and subsequent decline are complex. Similarly, the piece shifts suddenly from open and lyrical to ambient and discreet, ultimately building to a powerful climax. After all, to be reborn is to change significantly.

Score in C

(re)birth

for large orchestra

Adrian Zhang (2024)

♪=60
imitating sparseness

Flute 1
Flute 2
Flute 3
Oboe 1
Oboe 2
Oboe 3
Clarinets 1, 2 in B♭
Clarinet 3
Bassoons 1, 2
Bassoon 3
Horns in F 1, 2, 3, 4
Trumpets in C 1, 2, 3
Trombones 1, 2
Trombone 3
Tuba
Perc.
Tam-tam
Marimba
Vibraphone
Harp
Piano
Violin I
Violin II
Viola
Violoncello
Double Bass

airy, but pitched
To Picc.
A
1.
2.
a2
flz.
mf
Triangle
motor on
bowed
l.v.
Fast fingertip rub down string
ord.
♪=60
sul pont.
1 solo
arco
ord.
tutti
arco sul ponticello
flying col legno battuto
pizz.

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7

Piccolo

Picc. — air sounds — air sounds — ord

Fl. 2 — ord

Fl. 3 — air sounds — ord

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Ob. 3

Cl. 1, 2

Cl. 3 — To B. Cl.

Bsn. 1, 2 — ord. — a2

Bsn. — flz. — To Cbsn. — Contrabassoon — ord.

Hn. 1, 2 — a2 air sounds

Hn. 3, 4 — air sounds — a2

C Tpt. 1, 2, 3 — a3

Tbn. 1, 2 — flz. — ord. — a2

Tbn. 3

Tba. — flz. — flz.

Perc. — l.v. — Large Gong

T.-t.

Mar. — l.v.

Vib. — bowed — ord. — l.v. — bowed — ord.

Hp. — l.v. — E♭ — L.H. — mute — R.H.

Pno. — R.H. silently hold — L.H.

Vln. I — div. 2 — ord. div. 2

Vln. II — flying col legno battuto — ord. div. 2

Vla. — ord. div. 2 — col batt. — ord.

Vc. — ord.

Db. — arco — ord. — simile.

11

B

Picc.
ad lib key click bursts
pp

Fl. 2
pp
mp

Fl. 3
pp

Ob. 1
ad lib key click bursts
pp

Ob. 2
ad lib key click bursts
pp

Ob. 3
ad lib key click bursts
pp

Cl. 1, 2
a2
ord.
pp

Cl. 3
Bass Clarinet in B♭
pp

Bsn. 1, 2
a2
pp

Cbsn.
ad lib key click bursts
pp

Hn. 1, 2
a2 normal pitch
p
a2

Hn. 3, 4
ord.
a2
p
a2
air sounds
fp

C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
a3
fp
mp
a3
p

Tbn. 1, 2
a2
air sounds
fp
mp
ord.
a2
p
a2
fp

Tbn. 3
air sounds
fp
mp
air sounds
fp

Tba.
air sounds
fp
mp
fp

Gong
superball
pp
mp

T.-t.
Tam-Tam
p
use triangle stick
scrape

Mar.

Vib.
bowed
p
mp
p
mp
p

Hp.
damp.
mf
E♮ A♭ B♭ C♭
bisbig.
pp
mp
pp
8va nat.
A♮
mf
C♮ B♮
bisbig.
pp

Pno.
p
8vb
p

B

Vln. I
unis.
pp

Vln. II
flying col legno battuto
pp

Vla.
div. 2
ppp
unis.
pp

Vc.
sul tasto
mf
div. in 2
p

Db.
sul tasto
p

15

Picc.

Fl. 2

Fl. 3

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Ob. 3

Cl. 1, 2

B. Cl.

Bsn. 1, 2

Cbsn.

Hn. 1, 2

Hn. 3, 4

C Tpt. 1, 2, 3

Tbn. 1, 2

Tbn. 3

Tba.

Gong

T.-t.

Mar.

Vib.

Hp.

Pno.

Vln. I

Vln. II

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

gliss.

To Eng. Hn.

English Horn

a2

flz. 1. 2. 3.

ord.

a3

abruptly damp.

unis.

18

C

lyrically; with fluidity

Picc.

Fl. 2

Fl. 3

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Eng. Hn.

Cl. 1, 2

B. Cl.

Bsn. 1, 2

Bsn. 3

Hn. 1, 2

Hn. 3, 4

C Tpt. 1, 2, 3

Tbn. 1, 2

Tbn. 3

Tba.

Gong

T.-t.

Mar.

Vib.

Hp.

Pno.

Vln. I

Vln. II

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

22

Picc.
Fl. 2
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Bsn. 3
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

mp
mf
p
ord.
a2
a3
con sordino
Triangle
bisbig.
nat.
8va
Ped.
I
II
S.T.
div. 2

26

accel. ♪=70

D

E

Picc.
Fl. 2
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Bsn. 3
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Tri.
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

ord.
flz.
a2
hard mallet
mute
l.v.
pizz.
arco
div. 2
div in 2
unis.
sub.

31

Picc.
Fl. 2
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Cbsn.
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Tri.
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

air sounds (indefinite pitch)
air sounds
pitch bend
ord.
airy pitch
1.solo
airy
flz.
a2
(con sord.)
soft mallet
l.v.
C♯
alternate R.H. and L.H.
unis.
molto vibrato
div. 2
gliss.
sul pont.

F

with increased agitation

34

Picc.

Fl. 2

Fl. 3

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Eng. Hn.

Cl. 1, 2

B. Cl.

Bsn. 1, 2

Cbsn.

Hn. 1, 2

Hn. 3, 4

C Tpt. 1, 2, 3

Tbn. 1, 2

Tbn. 3

Tba.

Tri.

T.-t.

Mar.

Vib.

Hp.

Pno.

Vln. I

Vln. II

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

To Fl.

Flute

ord.

air sounds (indefinite pitch)

1. air sounds (indefinite pitch)

2.

a2

airy pitch

senza sordino

Large Gong

soft mallet

bowed

alternate R.H. and L.H.

F

div 2.

senza vibrato

sul pont.

39

Fl. 1
Fl. 2
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Cbsn.
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

superball
bowed
bowed
ord.
l.v.
l.v.
l.v.
1.
2.

42

Fl. 1
Fl. 2
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Cbsn.
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

a2
To Bsn.
Bassoon
use back/stem of mallets to produce clicking sound
alternate R.H. and L.H.
unis
div. 2

G

44

To Picc.

Piccolo

flz.

ord.

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Fl. 3

Ob. 1

ad lib key click bursts

Ob. 2

ad lib key click bursts

Eng. Hn.

Cl. 1, 2

B. Cl

ad lib key click bursts

Bsn. 1, 2

a2

Bsn. 3

Hn. 1, 2

Hn. 3, 4

C Tpt. 1, 2, 3

a3

Tbn. 1, 2

a2

Tbn. 3

Tba.

Gong

occasionally accent!

T.-t.

occasionally accent!

use back/stem of mallets to produce clicking sound

with superball

Mar.

Vib.

Hp.

Pno.

G

Vln. I

senza vib.
unis.

solo
molto sul ponticello (on bridge)

Vln. II

senza vibrato

molto sul ponticello (on bridge)

Vla.

senza vibrato

solo

Vc.

senza vib.

Db.

senza vibrato

47

Picc.
Fl. 2
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Bsn. 3
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

a2
ad lib key click bursts
To B. Cl.
triangle stick
scrape
ord. soft mallet
ord.
play highest pitches
flying col legno battuto
col legno batt.
tutti
a3

H frantically; with haste

49

Picc.
Fl. 2
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Bsn. 3
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

a2
a3
scrape
ord. soft mallet
ord.
l.v.
use back/stem of mallets to produce clicking sound

51

Picc.
Fl. 2
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Bsn. 3
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

ord.
ord. soft mallet

52

Picc.

Fl. 2

ord

Fl. 3

8va 1,2 ord

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Eng. Hn.

Cl. 1, 2

B. Cl.

ad lib key click bursts

Bsn. 1, 2

a2

Bsn. 3

ad lib key click bursts

Hn. 1, 2

Hn. 3, 4

C Tpt. 1, 2, 3

a3

Tbn. 1, 2

a2

Tbn. 3

Tba.

Gong

scrape

T.-t.

scrape

ord.

ord. soft mallet

Mar.

Vib.

bowed

bowed

Hp.

Pno.

Vln. I

ord.
arco

Vln. II

ord.
arco

Vla.

arco

Vc.

Db.

54

Picc. — ad lib key click bursts — pp f — fff
Fl. 2 — ad lib key click bursts — pp f — fff
Fl. 3 — ad lib key click bursts — pp f — fff
Ob. 1 — ad lib key click bursts — pp f — fff
Ob. 2 — ad lib key click bursts — pp f — fff
Eng. Hn. — ad lib key click bursts — pp — f ff p
Cl. 1, 2 — a2 ad lib key click bursts — pp — a2 f ff p
B. Cl. — f — f
Bsn. 1, 2 — a2 — f — a2 ff p
Bsn. 3 — f
Hn. 1, 2 — f — f
Hn. 3, 4 — f — f
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3 — ff f mf — fff ff
Tbn. 1, 2 — a2 — ff f mf — fff ff
Tbn. 3 — ff f mf
Tba. — ff f mf
Gong — mf — (p
T.-t. — mp
Mar. — f
Vib. — bowed — p mp
Hp. — fff
Pno. — fff — bisb. fff
Vln. I — ff
Vln. II — ff
Vla. — ff
Vc. — ff
Db. — ff

use contrabass bow

distant; desolate

I ♪=60

56

Picc.

Fl.

Fl. 3

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Eng. Hn. — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp

Cl. 1, 2 — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp

B. Cl. — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp

Bsn. 1, 2 — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp — "correct pitch" not required — a2 — pp

Bsn. 3 — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp — To Cbsn. — Contrabassoon — pp

Hn. 1, 2 — a2 — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp

Hn. 3, 4 — a2 — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp

C Tpt. 1, 2, 3 — a3 — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp

Tbn. 1, 2 — a2 — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp — con sordino

Tbn. 3 — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp

Tba. — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mp — con sordino

Gong — let dissipate — fffff

T.-t.

Mar.

Vib.

Hp.

Pno.

I ♪=60 — sul ponticello — solo IV

Vln. I — fff — pppp

Vln. II — fff

Vla. — fff — con sordino

Vc. — fff — con sord. — (con sord.) — p

Db. — fff — con sord. — (con sord.) — pppp — (con sord.) — p

65

Picc.
Fl.
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Cbsn.
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

air sounds (indefinite pitch)
air sounds (indefinite pitch) desk 1
air sounds (indefinite pitch) a2
"correct pitch" not required
1.
2.
div. 2 (con sord.)
(con sord.)
use triangle stick
play off-kilter, intentionally skipping some notes
silently hold
solo
col legno battuto
ord. molto s.p. (on bridge)
div. 2
div 2.
div 2
senza sordino
s. p.
unis.
s. t.

76 J

Picc.
Fl.
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Cbsn.
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

air sounds (indefinite pitch)
air sounds (indefinite pitch) a2
scrape
damp.
bowed damp.
simile.
superball l.v.
superball
bowed. damp.
silently hold
molto s.p. (on the bridge)
solo damp.
solo
simile.
pizz.
arco.
arco
col batt.
ord.
molto s.p. (on bridge)
damp. simile.
s. p.
s. t.
unis.
a3

83

K with hints of development

Picc. — pp mf

Fl. —

Fl. 3 — pp mf — air sounds (indefinite pitch)

Ob. 1 — fp mf

Ob. 2 —

Eng. Hn. — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mf

Cl. 1, 2 — air sounds (indefinite pitch) a2 — fp mf

B. Cl. — air sounds (indefinite pitch) — fp mf

Bsn. 1, 2 —

Cbsn. —

Hn. 1, 2 —

Hn. 3, 4 —

C Tpt. 1, 2, 3 —

Tbn. 1, 2 — a2 — pp mf — senza sordino

Tbn. 3 —

Tba. — senza sordino — pp mf

Gong — f — p mf — superball p

T.-t. — mf — p f

Mar. — ord. — mp — p mp p mp p — 8va ord. p — mf

Vib. — hard mallet ord. — p mp p — bowed mf

Hp. — p mp p ppp — mf

Pno. —

Vln. I — col batt. — flying col legno battuto — ord. — K — tutti mf — molto sul pont. (on bridge) III solo mp — s. p. tutti p mp

Vln. II — col batt. — ord. sul pont. — mp p — tutti mf

Vla. — tutti sul pont. — mp p p — ord. pp

Vc. — div 2 — s. t. — p mp — s. p. — s. t. — sul tasto — pp p — s. p. — s. t. — unis. mp mf

Db. — senza sord. — mp — mf f mf f

89

Picc.
Fl.
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Cbsn.
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

ord. flz. p mp
a2
8vb
use triangle stick
scrape
damp.
ord. soft mallet
sul pont. m.s.p. s.p. m.s.p. s.p.
II III II II
vib. molto vib. ord. pressure
s.p. arco. ord.
press. ord.

94

L climactically; with strength

Picc.
Fl.
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Cbsn.
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

ord. flz. p mp mf ff a2 a3 hard mallet (8) m.s.p. s.p. press.

97

Picc.
Fl.
Fl. 3
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Eng. Hn.
Cl. 1, 2
B. Cl.
Bsn. 1, 2
Cbsn.
Hn. 1, 2
Hn. 3, 4
C Tpt. 1, 2, 3
Tbn. 1, 2
Tbn. 3
Tba.
Gong
T.-t.
Mar.
Vib.
Hp.
Pno.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Db.

ord. flz. p mp mf f ff a2 tutti use gong mallet use contrabass bow use tam-tam mallet damp. soft mallet l.v. pizz. M